STUDENT ADVOCACY REPORT #3

Fall 2026 Update

Covers late April through October 8, 2026

Summary

The biggest change since spring: SPASD's new superintendent, Dr. Antoine Reed, is open to a district-wide Student Advisory Council. Students also helped interview the superintendent finalists, the weighted grades work restarted this fall, and the Director of School Operations offered to help build a student-rights guide.

One thing is still stuck. Mandated-reporting information promised in March hasn't been shared. On the good side, a meeting with the district's equity and communications leaders is now set for October 20.

Student Advisory Council

On April 13, high school students met the three superintendent finalists and gave feedback. In a meeting this fall, Dr. Reed shared ideas for student voice:

- Two-way conversation and quarterly meetings with students
- Advisory teams of 3–5 students from each middle and high school, plus a parent team at each school
- More communication channels, including the district app and a shared calendar
- Building the council into the culture so it lasts through leadership changes

Next step: a written proposal for how members are chosen, how often they meet, and how the district responds to them.

Weighted grades

A student and staff work group aims to bring a weighted grades framework to the Board by the end of November, in time for the December course guides. The group agreed on a 5.0 scale for weighted courses and is writing criteria rather than picking classes one by one. A caregiver survey, in English and Spanish, goes out in October.

Student rights and Title IX

After the federal Title IX change, the district confirmed that its own nondiscrimination and anti-bullying policies still protect students based on sexual orientation, gender identity, and other protected classes. Students can report concerns through Speak Up Speak Out. The Director of School Operations offered to help create a plain-language student-rights guide.

How the budget works

From an August 18 meeting with the Director of Business & Finance: about 80% of spending is staff, enrollment drives revenue, and state aid per student isn't tied to inflation. A separate one-page explainer is on the site.

Still waiting

- Student-facing information on mandated reporting (asked March 2)

Coming up: a meeting with the district's equity and communications leaders on October 20.

Next 60 days

- Send Dr. Reed a Student Advisory Council proposal
- Start the student-rights guide
- Help finish the weighted grades framework
- Share a summary of survey results

Independent and student-led. Written by Zackary Mark, a high school student in the Sun Prairie Area School District. Not an official SPASD document and does not speak for the district, its staff, or its Board. Shared in good faith; not meant to accuse any person. Contact: zackarymark160@gmail.com · Instagram @spasdstudentvoice